GIRIDHARAN RAJENDRAN

Senior Engineering Leader | Engineering Manager | DevSecOps | Platform Engineering | AI Agentic Systems
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Engineering Leader and Engineering Manager with 20 years building and scaling high-performing global engineering teams across cloud infrastructure, SRE, DevSecOps, Platform Engineering, and AI-powered agentic systems. Proven people manager: led 12-member SRE team and 14-person cross-functional team; drove hiring, performance management, career development, and succession planning. Pioneered T-Mobile's first AI-agentic developer continuous delivery platform — built CDP-MCP Server using Anthropic's Model Context Protocol (MCP) standard, powered by Claude, and deployed on T-Mobile's tag.ai AI gateway. Impact: $1.2M+ cost savings, 5x deployments, 25% team satisfaction improvement, 3,100+ compliance hours saved annually. Trusted C-suite partner for strategic planning, executive communication, and OKR-driven engineering roadmaps.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Engineering Leadership and Management | People Management and Talent Development | Headcount Planning | Performance Management | Career Development | Employee Engagement | Succession Planning | Executive Communication | Stakeholder Management | Strategic Planning | Technical Program Management | SRE | DevSecOps | Cloud Architecture (AWS, Azure, GCP) | AI Agentic Systems | MCP | GenAI | IaC | High Availability | Cloud-Native Architecture | DevEx | Zero Trust Security | Kubernetes | CI/CD | GitOps | Observability | FinOps | Disaster Recovery | Agile | SAFe | OKRs

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership: People management, headcount planning, hiring, performance management, career development, succession planning, employee engagement, vendor management, budget governance, architecture review boards

AI and GenAI: Anthropic Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude API, LLM, RAG, ChromaDB, AI agentic systems, MCP server development, Claude Code integration, prompt engineering

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, IAM, Lambda), Azure (AKS, ADO, Key Vault, Data Explorer), GCP; multi-cloud, high availability

DevSecOps and CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, ArgoCD, GitOps, SonarQube, SAST/DAST, policy-as-code, zero trust, SOX compliance

Containers and IaC: Kubernetes (EKS, AKS), Docker, Helm, Istio, Terraform, Ansible, Python, Golang, FastAPI, Next.js, Backstage.io

Observability and SRE: Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog, Splunk, SLI/SLO/SLA, chaos engineering, MTTR reduction, incident management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Leader — SRE, DevSecOps and Platform Engineering | **T-Mobile USA** | Oct 2019 – Present

- Built and scaled 12-member SRE team — hiring, performance management, career development, succession planning; team **satisfaction +25% YoY,** engineers promoted into leadership roles.
- Architected **100+ workload** migration to Azure/Kubernetes (Terraform, ArgoCD, GitOps) — 85% cost reduction, $1.2M+ annual savings.
- **CDP Hub — AI-Powered Platform (Flagship Innovation Project):** Pioneered T-Mobile's official Continuous Delivery Platform (CDP) developer portal — unified interface consolidating GitLab CI/CD tooling, platform observability, self-service automation, and organizational intelligence. Core: AI assistant powered by Claude delivering instant answers from CDP documentation, runbooks, pipeline data, and organizational context; Jira integration; real-time platform monitoring. **Reduced CDP support tickets 65% and** improved customer satisfaction across engineering teams; accelerated software delivery across T-Mobile.
- Built CDP-MCP Server on Anthropic's Model Context Protocol (MCP) — enabling developers to connect via Claude Code, VSCode, or Cursor to invoke 22+ CDP tools autonomously through natural language; deployed on T-Mobile's tag.ai AI gateway. Enabled **engineers to troubleshoot 80% of CDP** platform and pipeline failures through natural language queries.
- **Autobahn Program — Frictionless Developer Onboarding (CDP Single Point of Contact):** Served as CDP's single point of contact for T-Mobile's Autobahn program (expanded scope with TFE integration, formerly Moonshot); delivered AI-integrated CDP Hub and CDP-MCP Server in production. Reduced 23 manual onboarding intakes to a single self-service workflow — cutting **app-to-production time from 2–3 weeks to 60 minutes**. Earned Raise the Bar Award, Q2 2026, recognized by Director Rob Hansen.
- **FTE Reporter Access Rollout (4,800+ T-Mobile FTEs):** Executed read-only Reporter access rollout to 4,800+ T-Mobile FTEs on gitlab.com/tmobile — controlled batches then automated SAML group link; zero errors, fully automated; new joiners get access on first sign-in, auto-revoked on separation.
- Built GitLab CI/CD with SAST/DAST, SonarQube, policy-as-code — deployment frequency 5x, build reliability +60%.
- **SOX CM.02/CM.03 Compliance Automation:** Automated Change and Configuration Management controls across 22 SOX applications — 264+ hrs/month saved (3,100+ annually), 100% audit readiness, zero findings; built CSDM Check (Internal T-Mobile Tool) on ServiceNow CSDM for real-time SOX, PCI, USGCI compliance from CMDB — improved compliance audit time by 90%.
- Architected observability platform (Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog) — MTTR -45%, outages -30% YoY, 99.9% high availability; executive KPI dashboards cut reporting time 75%.
- Drove C-suite stakeholder management, strategic planning, and OKR-driven roadmap; led architecture review boards and vendor management.

Associate Manager, Software Engineering | **Accenture** | Sep 2010 – Oct 2019

- People management lead, 14-person cross-functional DevOps team — hiring, performance reviews, career development; delivery velocity +65% through Agile/CI/CD adoption.
- Directed T-Mobile Rebellion modernization — automation frameworks cutting release cycles 70%; technical standards adopted org-wide through automation-first SRE architecture.

- Automated 90% of manual ops; 99.9% SLA across 52+ apps with 24x7 on-call support; monitoring boosted incident response 60%; OKR roadmaps with executive leadership.

Senior Software Engineer | **Alcatel-Lucent** | Oct 2009 – Sep 2010

- Designed Unix/Python automation tooling and REST API integrations; independently architected deployment pipelines — manual overhead -30%.

System Engineer | Wipro Technologies (Jan 2008 – Sep 2009) Junior Engineer | LASON India Pvt Ltd (May 2006 – Sep 2007)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- **T-Mobile MVP Award, Q2 2026 —** Recognized for outstanding overall platform impact and customer experience improvement.
- **University of Phoenix President's List, Jan–Jun 2026 —** Highest academic standing in MBA program while working full-time at T-Mobile.
- **University of Phoenix Dean's List —** Exceptional academic achievement in the MBA program.

SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- **Speaker, GitLab Commit (Global DevOps Conference):** Represented T-Mobile presenting "Build Together, Grow Together — Inner Source Templates"; featured by GitLab (1.1M+ followers); 73 engagements, 18 comments from global DevOps community.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA), Graduated with Distinction — University of Phoenix (2026) | President's List, Jan–Jun 2026

Post Graduate Program in Cloud Computing — University of Texas at Austin (2021)

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Electronics and Communication Engineering — Anna University, India (2005)

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

AI and ML

- Generative AI and ML Fundamentals (2025) | Agentic AI (2026) | AI Risk Management (2026) | Databricks Generative AI Fundamentals (2024)
- ML and Supervised Learning — Skillsoft (2025) | AI Ethical Challenges and Risks — Skillsoft (2025)

DevOps, Architecture and Leadership

- GitLab Certified Git Associate (2024) | Red Hat Certified Engineer RHCE | SRE Management (2025) | Certified Technology Architect (2012)
- SAFe 5 Product Owner and Product Manager (2022) | Leadership Development Program (2025)

MBA Badges (University of Phoenix)

- Strategic Leadership | Financial Management | Operational Efficiency